

Interest Group Annual Report

Darwin Core

Web Site: <https://dwc.tdwg.org/>

Convener(s):	
Name	Email Address
John Wieczorek	gtuco.btuco@gmail.com

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Phase of work:

In addition to the ongoing maintenance of the Darwin Core Standard, the Interest Group is currently active in two related lines of standard development. The first of these is the incorporation of the Humboldt Extension for ecological inventories. The public review for this has now ended and a request for ratification of this set of vocabulary enhancements will be presented to the Executive Committee as soon as the Humboldt Extension Task Group finalizes recommendations.

The second line of development is the investigation of a semantic layer for Darwin Core that provides the relationships between the classes in Darwin Core and its extensions. This activity is in an early phase in which the applicability of various technological options is being considered along with the applicability of the use case-based Unified Conceptual Model under development with GBIF.

Activities:

Summary:

- The primary mode of collaboration for the Darwin Core standard is through its GitHub issue tracker (<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues>), with public review announcements via the tdwg-content listserv, TDWG news items, and social media coverage. There are ad hoc email messages and meetings between the members of the Interest Group to facilitate administrative maintenance issues. These are not publicly available.
- Participation in Task Groups working on vocabulary enhancements to Darwin Core have been through open Zoom meetings (not recorded) and GitHub issues (<https://github.com/tdwg/material-sample/issues> for the Material Sample Task Group and <https://github.com/tdwg/hc/issues> for the Humboldt Extension Task Group).

- During the reporting period, one open Darwin Core public review was successfully completed (<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/milestone/16>), the Material Sample Task Group proposals were successfully ratified and incorporated (<https://github.com/tdwg/material-sample/milestone/1>), and the Humboldt Extension Task Group public review was completed successfully (<https://github.com/tdwg/hc/milestone/1>), with the ratification request to be submitted as soon as possible.

Accomplishments:

The accomplishments of the Interest Group are documented as the results of the activities summarized above.

Impediments to progress:

None

Changes in goals or scope

None

Plans for next calendar year

- Finish Humboldt Extension Public Review and ratification request. Provide updated extension schemas to GBIF so that Darwin Core Event data sets can also include data in the Humboldt Extension. Hopefully this can all be accomplished by the end of January 2024.
- Continue with the investigation of technologies and applicability of the GBIF Unified Model as a starting point for a Darwin Core semantic layer. This activity is expected to continue throughout 2024.